WAVERLEY GATEWAY GUIDE

Connecting International Capital

CHILE

Latin America

Information current as of October 2026

Dialogue | Trust | Partnership

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WHERE AND HOW TO ENTER

KEY INVESTMENT LOCATIONS

Location / Region	Strategic Importance	Priority Sectors
Santiago (Metropolitan Region)	Capital and commercial centre; seat of government, the Central Bank, InvestChile and most corporate headquarters	Financial services, global services and technology, real estate, retail
Antofagasta Region (north)	Heart of the world's largest copper industry and the Salar de Atacama lithium operations, with exceptional solar resources	Copper and lithium mining, mining services, solar energy, battery storage
Atacama Region and Maricunga salt flat	Copper and gold district and the Maricunga lithium concessions transferred to Codelco under the Codelco–SQM agreement	Mining, lithium, renewable energy
Valparaíso and San Antonio (central coast)	Chile's principal container gateways serving Santiago and central-zone exporters	Port logistics, agri-food exports, warehousing
Biobío and the central-south	Industrial and forestry heartland with established manufacturing and port infrastructure	Forestry and pulp, manufacturing, agri-food
Los Lagos and Aysén (south)	Centre of Chile's salmon aquaculture industry; the 2026 reform package addresses relocation of aquaculture concessions	Aquaculture, food processing, tourism
Magallanes (far south)	Strong wind resources and Chile's leading green-hydrogen region, home to the country's first approved green hydrogen project	Green hydrogen and e-fuels, wind energy, port infrastructure

INVESTOR ENTRY ROUTES

- InvestChile, the national investment promotion agency established under Law 20,848, connects investors with opportunities and issues foreign investor certificates online within up to 15 working days; it tracked a $65.7 billion foreign project portfolio at end-2025
- Law 20,848 (Foreign Investment Promotion Law) guaranteeing equal, non-discriminatory treatment of foreign and domestic investors, with prior authorisation generally required only in a few areas such as hydrocarbons and nuclear energy

- Free capital movement under Chapter XIV of the Central Bank's Compendium of Foreign Exchange Regulations (new version in force from 1 January 2026): transfers above $10,000 go through the formal exchange market and are reported, with no restriction on repatriating capital or profits
- The 2026 pro-growth reform package approved by Congress on 4 August 2026, which lowers corporate tax gradually from 27% to 23% by 2029 and streamlines environmental permitting, with some provisions under Constitutional Court review
- Lithium participation through partnership with state companies under CORFO contracts, as with NovaAndino Litio, the Codelco–SQM joint venture operating the Salar de Atacama until 2060
- A network of 34 trade agreements covering more than 60 economies, alongside double taxation treaties that reduce the 35% additional tax on remitted profits

MARKET-ENTRY OBSERVATION

Chile in October 2026 offers one of Latin America's most open and institutionally stable investment environments, anchored by an A-range credit rating (Fitch A-, S&P A, Moody's A2) and an independent central bank. Exports reached a record $107 billion in 2025, up 7.9%, led by mining exports of $63.3 billion, and foreign direct investment rose 13% to $14.2 billion. The investment pipeline is strengthening: InvestChile's foreign project portfolio grew 16.8% to $65.7 billion at end-2025, led by energy, and the Capital Goods Corporation's 2026–2030 pipeline rose 32% in the first quarter of 2026 to $87.7 billion, driven by mining. President José Antonio Kast's reform package, approved by Congress in August 2026, cuts corporate tax from 27% to 23% by 2029 and speeds up permitting, and the Central Bank projects investment growth of 8.1% in 2027.

Chile's main near-term task is converting this investment pipeline into renewed growth. Activity was flat in the first half of 2026 (GDP -0.2% year-on-year in Q2), as large mining projects completed and ore grades weighed on output, and the Central Bank has set its 2026 growth range at 0.25–0.75% before a recovery to 2–3% in 2027. Inflation of 4.1% in September reflects higher fuel prices linked to the Middle East conflict, while core inflation is steady at around 3.3% and the policy rate is held at 4.5%. Chile's buffers are substantial: copper prices above $6.50 per pound support export earnings, the current account is projected in surplus in 2026, and gross public debt is projected to peak at around 44% of GDP, below the government's 45% prudence threshold. For investors, the combination of a cyclical low, lower taxes ahead and a deep project pipeline creates an attractive entry point.

INVESTOR RISK & MARKET ACCESS

KEY ENTRY BARRIERS

Issue	Potential Impact	Possible Mitigation
Cyclical slowdown in 2026	GDP was broadly flat in the first half of 2026 and the Central Bank projects 0.25–0.75% growth this year	A projected rebound to 2–3% growth and 8.1% investment growth in 2027 makes the current period an attractive entry point for long-term investors
Reform implementation timing	Some reform provisions, including tax stability for new investments and permitting changes, are under Constitutional Court review, and rollout may be phased	Structure projects on provisions already in force and seek legal advice on tax-stability timing; the approved corporate tax path to 23% is a clear medium-term gain
US tariff measures	A 12.5% US Section 301 surcharge applies to some Chilean goods and semi-finished copper faces 50% under Section 232, although refined copper, lithium and several fruits are exempt	Chile's 2004 FTA with the US and active negotiations support market access, while its network of 34 agreements allows exporters to diversify markets
Mining output and ore grades	Lower ore grades and operational stoppages are expected to reduce mining output in 2026	Mining makes up 41% of the $87.7 billion investment pipeline, creating demand for technology, processing and mining services that improve productivity
Environmental permitting and community engagement	Permitting for large projects has historically been lengthy, and project acceptance depends on early community engagement	The reform package streamlines permitting; early stakeholder engagement and experienced local advisers shorten timelines
State-led lithium model	Lithium is a strategic resource reserved to the state, so private participation is	The Codelco–SQM NovaAndino agreement to 2060 provides a clear template for

Issue	Potential Impact	Possible Mitigation
	through partnerships with state companies	public–private participation
Fuel-driven inflation	Headline inflation of 4.1% reflects higher diesel and petrol prices linked to the Middle East conflict	Core inflation is stable at around 3.3% and the Central Bank expects a return to its 3% target in Q2 2027; standard hedging covers peso exposure

INVESTOR RISK NOTE

Chile's risk profile is that of a well-governed, investment-grade economy passing through a cyclical slowdown rather than a structural weakness. An independent central bank, free capital movement, non-discriminatory treatment of foreign investors under Law 20,848 and A-range sovereign ratings provide a predictable framework, and 2025 delivered record exports and a 13% rise in FDI. The 2026 slowdown reflects the completion of large mining projects and lower ore grades, while the investment pipeline has expanded sharply and the Central Bank expects growth to recover to 2–3% in 2027. The main points to plan for are the phased rollout of the 2026 reform package, with some provisions under Constitutional Court review, and US tariff measures on certain non-copper exports. Both are manageable with sound legal advice and Chile's broad trade-agreement network, and the reform package's lower corporate tax and faster permitting point to an improving environment over the medium term.

MARKET ACCESS

Chile has one of the world's most extensive trade-agreement networks, with 34 agreements in force covering more than 60 economies, including a free trade agreement with the United States since 2004, the Comprehensive and Progressive Agreement for Trans-Pacific Partnership (CPTPP), the Pacific Alliance and an Interim Trade Agreement with the European Union that entered into force in 2025. It is a founding member of the WTO. China is the main export destination, particularly for copper and fruit, followed by the United States and the European Union. Mining accounted for 59% of goods exports in 2025, with copper concentrates alone reaching $36.3 billion, while fresh cherries ($3.4 billion) lead a record fruit sector. Chile's Pacific ports provide direct links to Asian markets, positioning it as a natural gateway between South America and the Asia-Pacific.

WHO SHOULD THE INVESTOR MEET?

INSTITUTIONAL LANDSCAPE

Actor	Why It Matters	Waverley Engagement Angle
Office of the President (José Antonio Kast)	Leads the pro-growth agenda, including the 2026 reform package cutting corporate tax and accelerating permits	Primary reference point for Chile's economic strategy and reform priorities
InvestChile	National investment promotion agency created under Law 20,848; tracks a $65.7 billion foreign project portfolio	Standard first point of contact for market entry, project facilitation and investor certificates
Banco Central de Chile	Independent monetary authority (Governor Rosanna Costa) that sets the 4.5% policy rate and administers the foreign exchange regulations	Relevant for capital-flow reporting, repatriation and currency matters
Ministry of Finance	Leads fiscal policy, sovereign debt issuance and implementation of the tax elements of the reform package	Key for understanding tax incentives and fiscal direction
Codelco	State-owned copper producer and Chile's lithium partner through the NovaAndino Litio joint venture	Essential counterpart for mining, lithium and mining-services engagement
CORFO (Production Development Corporation)	State development agency that holds the lithium contracts in the Salar de Atacama and supports innovation and new industries	Relevant for lithium, green hydrogen and innovation-led investment
Undersecretariat for International Economic Relations (Subrei)	Manages Chile's 34 trade agreements and leads trade negotiations, including current	Relevant for export strategy and market-access questions

Actor	Why It Matters	Waverley Engagement Angle
	talks with the United States	

CURRENT INTERNATIONAL BUSINESS CHANNELS

The British Chamber of Commerce in Chile (Britcham), the American Chamber of Commerce in Chile (AmCham Chile) and the Confederation of Production and Commerce (CPC), the leading national business federation, are the main channels for business liaison, while the National Mining Society (Sonami) and the Capital Goods Corporation (CBC) provide sector intelligence on the mining and project pipeline. InvestChile runs investor outreach and sector briefings, and ProChile supports export-oriented partnerships. The World Bank, the Inter-American Development Bank and IDB Invest are active in infrastructure, energy transition and private-sector development, and Chile's deep capital markets and investment-grade sovereign provide a strong base for project finance.

INVESTOR PROFILE BEST SUITED

Chile suits long-term strategic investors seeking a stable, rules-based gateway to South America and the Asia-Pacific: mining and mining-services companies targeting copper, productivity technology and processing; energy investors in solar, wind, battery storage and green hydrogen, which lead InvestChile's portfolio; lithium and battery-supply-chain investors able to partner with state companies; infrastructure investors drawn to concessions and port and transmission projects; and global services and technology firms using Santiago as a regional hub. Agri-food and aquaculture investors benefit from Chile's counter-seasonal position and wide trade-agreement network.

FROM INTELLIGENCE TO ENGAGEMENT

STEP 1: Engage InvestChile and map the project pipeline
Open dialogue with the national investment promotion agency to identify opportunities in its $65.7 billion portfolio and obtain the foreign investor certificate.

STEP 2: Assess the 2026 reform package with legal and tax advisers
Review the corporate tax path to 23%, permitting changes and the status of provisions under Constitutional Court review when structuring investments.

STEP 3: Position for the 2027 investment recovery
Use the current cyclical low to secure partners, sites and permits ahead of the investment growth the Central Bank projects for 2027.

STEP 4: Explore partnerships in lithium, copper and energy
Engage Codelco, CORFO and private operators on public–private models such as NovaAndino Litio, and on renewable energy and storage projects.

STEP 5: Use Chile's trade agreements to plan market access
Work with Subrei and ProChile to design export routes that make full use of the 34 agreements and to track US tariff developments.